

HS4002

Research Paper
Presentation #1

Research Question

To what extent is economic insecurity associated with perceived justifiability of economic norms violation compared to personal norm violations?

Conceptualisations

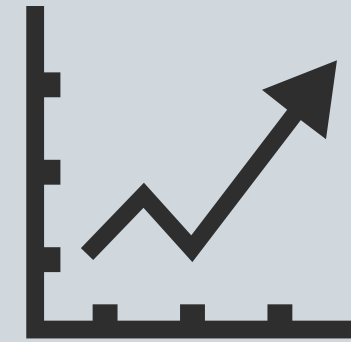
Merton's Strain Theory of Deviance

- Economic success is seen as a marker of achievement, yet employment opportunities are unequally distributed
→ individuals can feel strain
- People facing economic insecurity may be more likely to justify "immoral" acts for economic gain compared to other ones

Herbert Simon's Bounded Rationality

- Economic insecurity can constrain the resources and information individuals have when they have to make morally questionable decisions
- People facing economic insecurity may be more likely to use a heuristic of financial gain or survival instead of abstract moral norms

Variables



Independent Variable

Economic Insecurity

- Ability to afford basic necessities



Dependent Variable 1

Economic Norms Violation



Dependent Variable 2

Personal Norm Violations

Economic Insecurity

Definition:

- **An individual's perceived vulnerability to financial hardship and uncertainty regarding their economic circumstances**
- Individuals with similar income levels can experience different degrees of financial insecurity

ABILITY TO AFFORD BASIC NECESSITIES

- Food, shelter, medicine, etc
- Tells us if an individual is facing material deprivation or poverty

Moral Norms

Definition:

- A person's specific set of private beliefs, values, and internal standards used to determine what is right, wrong, good, or bad
- Personal and subjective view of right and wrong shaped by upbringing, culture, and life experiences

ECONOMIC NORMS

- Examines rule-violating actions for economic gain
- Stealing, bribery, etc

PERSONAL NORMS

- Views on personal and political issues
- Abortion, euthanasia, etc

Dataset

World Values Survey (WVS) Wave 7

- Micro-level perspectives collected on an international scale
- Surveys both material wellbeing and ethical norms, allowing us to understand how people;s beliefs are motivated by their situation
- Questions cover all the measures to assess our factors



Economic Insecurity

In the last 12 months, how often have you or your family...?

		Often	Sometimes	Rarely	Never
Q51	Gone without enough food to eat	1	2	3	4
Q52	Felt unsafe from crime in your home	1	2	3	4
Q53	Gone without medicine or medical treatment that you needed	1	2	3	4
Q54	Gone without a cash income	1	2	3	4
Q55	Gone without a safe shelter over your head	1	2	3	4

- “Often”, “sometimes”, “rarely” = some level of economic insecurity
- “Never” = stable economic situation

Economic Norms

(SHOW CARD 20)

Please tell me for each of the following actions whether you think it can always be justified, never be justified, or something in between, using this card. (Read out and code one answer for each statement):

		Never justifiable					Always justifiable				
Q177	Claiming government benefits to which you are not entitled	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Q178	Avoiding a fare on public transport	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Q179	Stealing property	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Q180	Cheating on taxes if you have a chance	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Q181	Someone accepting a bribe in the course of their duties	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10

- 1 = Never justifiable
- 10 = Always justifiable

Moral Norms

(SHOW CARD 20)

Please tell me for each of the following actions whether you think it can always be justified, never be justified, or something in between, using this card. (Read out and code one answer for each statement):

		Never justifiable							Always justifiable		
		1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Q182	Homosexuality	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Q183	Prostitution	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Q184	Abortion	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Q185	Divorce	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Q186	Sex before marriage	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Q187	Suicide	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Q188	Euthanasia	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Q189	For a man to beat his wife	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Q190	Parents beating children	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Q191	Violence against other people	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Q192	Terrorism as a political, ideological or religious mean	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Q193	Having casual sex	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Q194	Political violence	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Q195	Death penalty	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10

- 1 = Never justifiable
- 10 = Always justifiable

Code

Progress so far

SUMMARY

What we have accomplished:

- OLS for economic insecurity against economic norms for each country (7)
- OLS for economic insecurity against moral norms for each country (7)

What remains unresolved:

- Rescaling of questions 51, 53-55
- Question 287 (survey question on class) to refine measure of economic insecurity
- Clean up code and tables

What analysis we intend to complete next:

- Comparing beta coefficient of economic and moral norms for each country
- Comparison between countries and explaining their differences

Thank You

for your time
and attention